(3) If no employee in the saved grade status bids or applies to the former level duty assignments, the junior employee(s) in the saved grade status will have their saved grade taken away.

(4) An employee in saved grade status who bids or applies for a former wage level duty assignment and is declared the senior bidder but fails to qualify, will lose saved grade protection. No more than one (1) employee in the saved grade status group will have saved grade taken away for each former level duty assignment posted.

7. a. An employee who was not hired from a machine register and who has not subsequently passed machine training may not be involuntarily assigned to a machine duty assignment regardless of salary level. This provision does not prohibit the Employer from making a job offer to an unencumbered employee in the same level.

b. An employee hired from a machine register who has not qualified on a particular machine skill (e.g., letter sorting machine, flat sorting machine) may not be involuntarily assigned to a duty assignment requiring that machine skill until all unencumbered employees who have qualified on that machine skill have been assigned.

8. Full-time employees are assigned only to full-time residual vacancies.

D. Identification of Newly Established Duty Assignments

When the number of full-time regular Clerk Craft duty assignments in an installation is less than the number of full- time clerks, a full-time employee remaining unencumbered for a period of 120 calendar days shall

demonstrate the need to post the newly established full-time regular duty assignment in accordance with Article 37.3.A.1.a.

This process shall continue until all unencumbered clerks eligible to be assigned have successfully bid or been assigned to duty assignments.

Exceptions: Any full work or paid leave weeks (40 hours) during which unencumbered clerks are: 1) detailed to nonbargaining positions; 2) identified as impacted under the provisions of Article 12.5.C (excluding 12.5.C.4); or 3) medically unsuitable for assignment, shall not be included when establishing this 120-day period.

Section 5. Conversion/Part-Time Flexible Preference

A. General Principles

1. The Employer will maintain a single merged part-time flexible roll.
2. Part-time flexible employees shall be converted to full-time in the manner set forth in this Section.
3. When an opportunity exists for conversion to a vacant full-time Clerk Craft duty assignment, employees shall, in accordance with this Section, exercise a preference(s) as to the duty assignment(s) they desire to be converted into based on their standing on the part-time flexible roll.
4. Part-time flexible employees who have exercised a preference and fail to qualify shall not be discharged or disciplined as a result of such failure.
5. Part-time flexible preferencing under Section 5 will occur within 28 days after the application of Section 4.C, Assignment of Unencumbered Employees, unless such vacancies are being withheld pursuant to Article 12.
6. Normally, the senior part-time flexible stating a preference will be placed into training within ten (10) calendar days.